

What should you prepare before discussing a manufacturing subsidy?

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Start with a short project brief: what the business does, where the investment is being made, what you are spending on and which commitments have already happened. Then bring the records available to support that account.

You do not need a finished application file to have a useful first conversation. The purpose is to give the adviser a clear picture of the investment so the relevant programme and next step can be examined.

1. Describe the activity in plain language

Explain what the unit makes or processes, the main raw material and the output. If the investment is an expansion, describe the existing operation and what will change.

“Adding a production line at our existing unit” is a useful start. Add the type of line and how it changes the operation. “We need an MSME subsidy” identifies a broad interest but says little about the project behind it.

For an equipment purchase, explain what the machine does. A testing instrument, a production machine and a safety installation have different purposes. The purpose should be clear before the programme is discussed.

2. Identify the business making the investment

Keep the applicant business name and constitution available. If more than one entity or site is involved, explain which one holds the assets and which one is making the application.

A group turnover figure does not replace the records for the unit seeking assistance. Similarly, an owner's personal investment plan and expenditure already recorded in the business should not be presented as the same thing.

You can raise any uncertainty in the discussion. The important point is to identify it rather than fill the gap with an assumption.

3. Separate the expenditure categories

A single total can hide the parts that need to be examined. Put machinery, building, land and other costs in separate lines, using the records available.

Cost or figure	How to describe it
Proposed machinery	Quotation value and whether an order has been placed

Cost or figure	How to describe it
Purchased equipment	Invoice value, purchase date and payment position
Building work	Recorded or proposed expenditure and construction stage
Land or lease	The arrangement and available documents
Total project budget	The categories included in the total
Company turnover	A separate business measure, with the relevant period

Do not call every cost an eligible cost before the programme conditions have been examined. Keeping the categories separate makes that review easier.

4. Make a simple timeline

Write down the dates you know: order, invoice, payment, start of construction, installation and commercial production. Mark planned dates as planned and actual dates as actual.

If an invoice has been issued but payment is incomplete, say so. If one part of an expansion is operating while another is still being installed, explain the difference.

A timeline helps the adviser compare the project with the relevant programme's conditions. It also stops the application from relying on a date that describes a different milestone.

5. Bring the site and existing records

Keep the district, site address and available ownership or lease information ready. Add the registrations, permissions and correspondence connected to the unit.

You are not being asked to obtain every possible approval before the first discussion. The adviser needs to understand the documented position and identify what the actual assignment requires.

If a document is held by your architect, CA or another colleague, note who has it. That is more useful than guessing its contents.

6. Include earlier assistance and applications

Tell the adviser about benefits already claimed or received and any application currently in progress. Bring the relevant references and communication if available.

Different programmes can treat overlapping assistance differently. The review needs the history of the particular investment and applicant, not just the scheme you are considering today.

If an earlier application has a query, keep the actual communication. A short verbal summary can leave out the detail that the next response needs to address.

An example of a useful first brief

We operate a manufacturing unit in Haryana and are adding equipment at the same site. We have quotations for the new machines and invoices for part of the building work. One equipment order has been placed. Production on the new line has not started. Our CA holds the expenditure records, and our site consultant holds the land and approval documents. We want to understand the relevant incentive opportunity and the application work Rapid can manage.

This is an illustrative brief, not a client case or an eligibility statement. Its value is that it separates the activity, investment, stage and people holding the records.

What happens in the first discussion?

Rapid uses the brief to understand the requirement and identify the information needed for the next step. A formal assessment, application or response assignment is then defined through its own scope.

You should understand which work Rapid will manage, which inputs your team supplies and what the next milestone means. Application, sanction and release of funds remain separate stages.

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Questions about preparation

I have already bought machinery. Is it too late to speak?

Share the actual dates and records. The conversation should start from your current position. Whether a programme remains relevant depends on its conditions and the facts of the investment.

Do I need a scheme name first?

No. Explain the project. Identifying relevant programme questions is part of the advisory discussion.

Should my CA join?

It can help if they hold the expenditure or company records. A plant or site colleague may be useful for technical information. Bring the people relevant to the questions being discussed.

Turn your brief into the next step

Share the activity, district and investment you want to discuss. An expert consultant from Rapid will call you to understand the project and explain how we can take the advisory work forward.

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